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2025/2026 Civil UAS Sector Study RELEASED

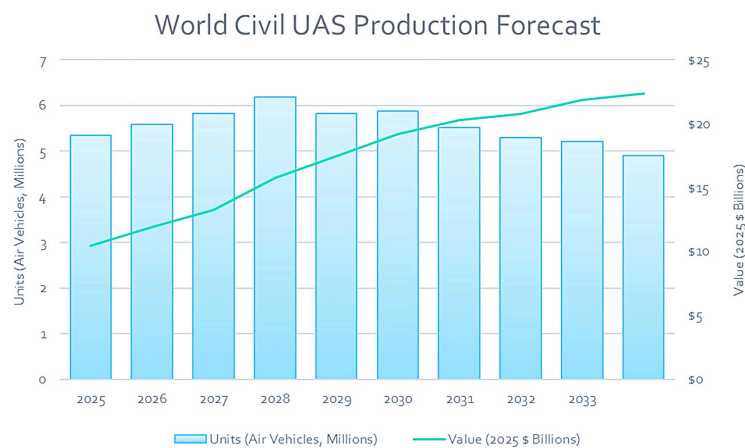
Author: J.J. Gertler (/index.php/about/analysts/j-j-gertler), Drawn From:
2025/2026 World Military Unmanned Aerial Systems Market Profile &
Forecast (<https://shop.tealgroup.com/products/wcuav>)

**The content presented below is taken from
Teal Group's**

***2025/2026 World Civil Unmanned Aerial
Systems Market Profile & Forecast
(<https://shop.tealgroup.com/products/wcuav>)***

The market for civil UAS will continue to be one of the most dynamic aerospace growth sectors through the beginning of the 2030s, emerging from a \$10.8 billion market (value of air vehicles) in 2025 to double to \$22.4 billion by 2034. That represents a 6.8% compound annual growth rate (CAGR) in constant dollars. Over the next 10 years the market will total \$178 billion.

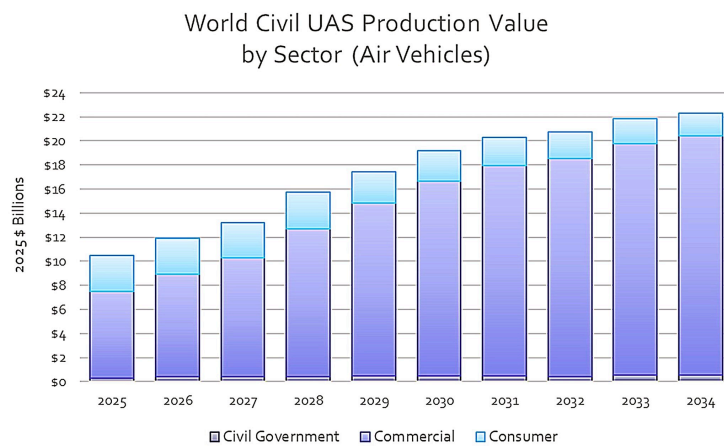
However, we forecast peak expansion for most sectors around 2029, as companies come to understand the requirements for UAS, the technology matures, acquisition moves from end users to service providers, and regulations stabilize. Many types will move more into a replacement cycle thereafter.



There are already signs of moderation in the market. In the last year, the number of UAS registered in the United States increased just 4%, even as the number of certificated operators increased 11%. (Of the 822,039 drones registered in the US, 433,407 are for commercial use and 377,484 recreational, a 53/46 split. However, that marks a significant change from the 50/50 split only a year ago, with the number of registered recreational drones falling 3%.)

The consumer systems and commercial systems segments began the forecast period in our 2024 study relatively close in annual production value of air vehicles at 67% and 29%, respectively. The gap between the two has widened quickly as consumer demand levels and begins to fall, while the unit cost of commercial systems has risen steadily, and both trends continue. By the end of our 10-year forecast, commercial systems will command 87% of the overall civil UAS market, while consumer systems will slip to 10% of air vehicle production value.

Commercial markets are developing at very different rates around the world. In countries that have moved quickly to adopt regulations, UAS are already in widespread use. In others, companies are doing proof of concept work to create foundations to deploy drones, while waiting for regulatory regimes to enable that deployment. They are working to prove cost savings and ensure data flowing from UAS can be integrated into businesses' workflows.



The overall commercial UAS market is moving from being platform-based to being service-based. We see the pattern of drone acquisition by individual end users in markets like energy, inspection, and agriculture giving way to acquisition by service providers. That means in the out years, there will be fewer customers for UAS, although those who do buy will buy more drones and use them harder.

This leads to the second important conclusion, that the drone market has become sufficiently mature that in many cases it is moving from an expansion to a replacement market. The first generations of drones have already been replaced by new ones, and as service providers increase the number of hours on each drone, that replacement cycle will accelerate. So while our numbers project the number of deliveries of new drones in each year, the total fleets will not continue to grow in the out years, because many of the new drones are replacing older ones taken out of service.

The combination of the move to a service-based market along with the move to a replacement market means that we do not foresee the same sort of 30 to 40% CAGRs in most sub-markets that some other analysts project.

Additionally, drones for the commercial market that are sold to end users will increasingly be packaged as part of an end-to-end service stack solution including software and services, meaning the dollar

value of the hardware – the drones themselves – will be becoming increasingly difficult to derive from the end value of each transaction.

The trend to reliance on service providers will be considerably less in the government markets discussed herein than commercial.

Of significant note, the 2025-2026 Study makes a very substantial change in our forecast for communications UAS, specifically the High-Altitude Pseudo Satellite portion of the market. We still believe that that technology has a significant future, but industry has moved so slowly on deploying those systems that we no longer see that sub-market reaching maturity within the 10-year forecast window.

World Civil Unmanned Aerial Systems Market Profile & Forecast (<https://shop.tealgroup.com/products/wmuav>) is an annual sector study that allows clients to identify lucrative potential business opportunities in the increasingly dynamic international military UAS market. It contains a wealth of timely intelligence and analysis on the systems, as well as requirements on a country-by-country basis.

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A veteran of aerospace program analysis since 1984, Jeremiah Gertler joined Teal Group in 2021, providing insight to private clients worldwide. He is the current editor of Teal's annual **World Civil UAS Market Profile and Forecast** (<https://shop.tealgroup.com/products/wcuav>).



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